

What is Safari?

Safari is Apple's self built web browser that comes pre-installed on all Apple devices. First released in 2003, a brainchild of Apple employee Don Melton and his team, Safari was built on the Webkit framework. The same framework was later adapted to the Blink framework, on which Google's Chrome browser is built.

Until 1997, the Mac was shipped with the proprietary browsers available at the time – Netscape Navigator, the flagship product of the Netscape company, and Cyberdog, developed by Apple itself – both have since been discontinued. In 1997, Apple made a deal with Microsoft to include the latter's Internet Explore as the default browser on all Macs. True to the Apple spirit, this was deeply bothersome to Steve Jobs, and he set in motion a project to build a stand-alone web browser with all the functionality a personal computer would require. In Don Melton's own words - "We built our own browser because we didn't want to depend on another company for a critical application."

With the existing Mac user base taking quite a liking to the new browser, development on Safari was accelerated after 2003, and Safari 2, released in 2005, became the first browser to pass the Acid2 test for web rendering. In fact, the Acid2 test was designed to expose inconsistencies in Internet



A screenshot of the Mac desktop, circa 2005. The SheepSaver window is an emulator for an older version (Mac OS 9). The host system itself is running Mac OS X 10.4 Tiger with an open Safari 2 window visible (bottom right)